

ClearForMe

Difficult text, made clear.

Hackathon 3: Equal Access

SDG 10 • Reduced Inequalities

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The problem

Government information is important — but not always understandable.

30%

of people in the Netherlands have difficulty with government texts.

What goes wrong?

- Abstract or unfamiliar words
- Long, information-heavy sentences
- It is not always clear what the reader needs to do

Why it matters

Government texts can contain deadlines, payments, conditions and decisions. Misunderstanding them can create a real information disadvantage.

3 million people aged 16–75 in the Netherlands have difficulty with reading, writing and/or numeracy.

Sources: Taalunie, Monitor Begrijpelijkheid overheidsteksten (2023); Stichting Lezen en Schrijven (2026).

Who is it for?

Adults who have difficulty reading and understanding complex government language.

Primary user

Adults in the Netherlands who have difficulty understanding complex written government communication.

They may struggle with formal vocabulary, long sentences or knowing which action is expected from them.

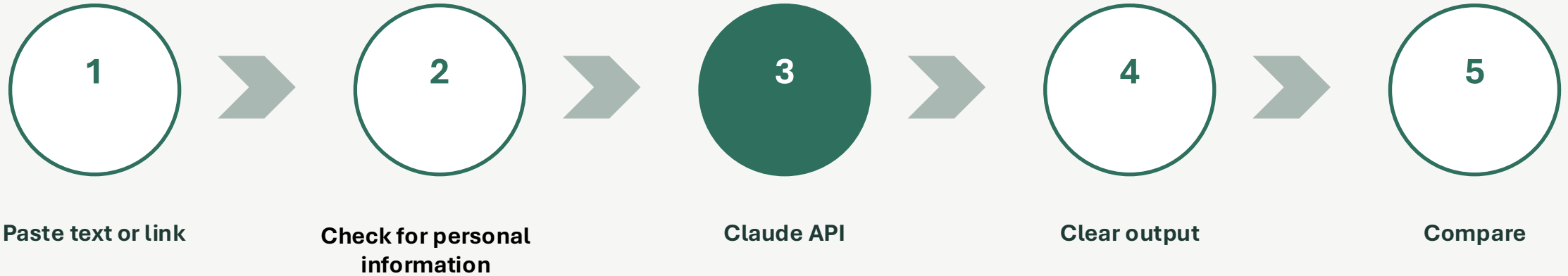
Typical situation

A user receives a Dutch government letter or reads an official webpage. The information matters to them, but the wording makes it difficult to understand the message, next step or deadline.

Not the goal ClearForMe is not legal advice and does not replace the original document.

Our solution

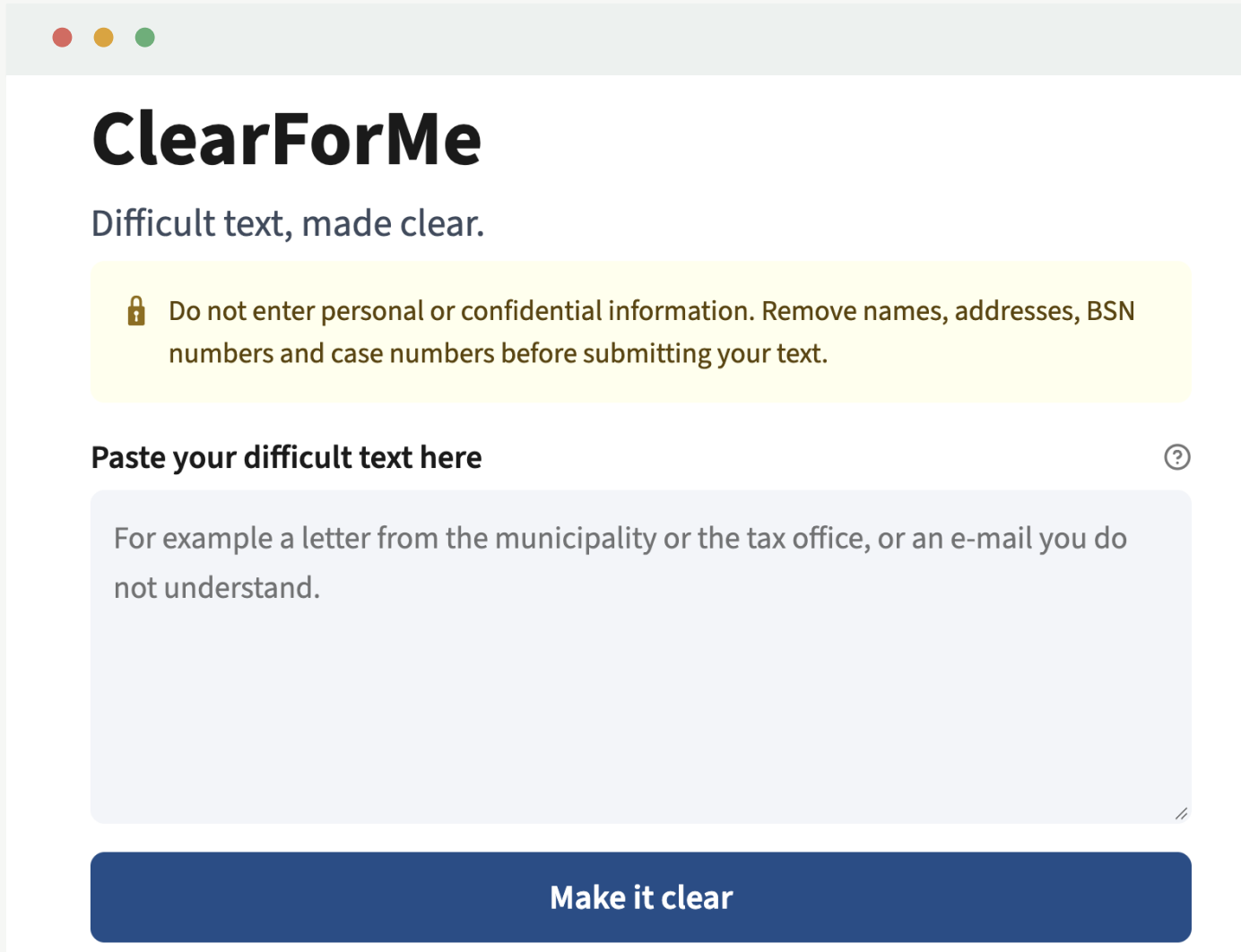
A simple companion for difficult Dutch government text.



Output: Simple explanation • What do I need to do? • Important dates & details • Difficult words

What we built

A Python + Streamlit web app with a live Claude API call.



The screenshot shows a web application window with a title bar (red, yellow, green buttons). The main heading is "ClearForMe" in a large, bold, black font. Below it is the tagline "Difficult text, made clear." in a smaller, dark blue font. A yellow warning box contains a lock icon and the text: "Do not enter personal or confidential information. Remove names, addresses, BSN numbers and case numbers before submitting your text." Below this is a section titled "Paste your difficult text here" with a help icon (question mark in a circle). The text area is a light blue box with the placeholder text: "For example a letter from the municipality or the tax office, or an e-mail you do not understand." At the bottom is a large, dark blue button with the text "Make it clear" in white.

Python-native

Streamlit interface + Anthropic Python SDK

Live AI

The pasted text is sent to Claude only after the user clicks the button.

Structured result

Claude returns JSON; Python validates it before anything is shown.

Why Claude is necessary

The AI performs the core transformation, not just a decorative feature.

Input

A new government text can be pasted every time. The app cannot know in advance which words, actions, dates or conditions the text contains.

Claude

Claude reads the specific text, simplifies its meaning, identifies the requested action, preserves important details and explains difficult words.

Without the LLM, ClearForMe would not dynamically understand and simplify unseen texts.

Safety & edge cases

The target group may have difficulty spotting an AI mistake, so safeguards matter.

Privacy

Before sending anything, the user must confirm that personal and confidential information has been removed. The API call only happens after a deliberate click.

 Do not enter personal or confidential information. Remove names, addresses, BSN numbers and case numbers before submitting your text.

AI mistakes

The prompt tells Claude not to invent information and to preserve dates, amounts, deadlines and conditions. The original text remains available for comparison.

Technical failures

The app handles empty input, text that is too long, missing/invalid API keys, rate limits, connection errors, no answer and malformed JSON.

User warning

Every result states that AI can make mistakes and that important information must always be checked in the original text.

Why this fits SDG 10

Reduced inequalities through more equal access to understandable information.

Complex government language → information disadvantage → ClearForMe adds an accessible explanation

Specific inequality

Not everyone has the same ability to understand formal government communication.

Specific intervention

ClearForMe converts each pasted text into simpler Dutch and highlights the next step and key details.

Meaningful value

The prototype works end-to-end and provides more than a generic chatbot response: privacy, structure, validation and comparison are built into the flow.

ClearForMe supports understanding — the user still makes their own decisions based on the official text.

Demo

From difficult text to clear next steps.

1

Paste a safe fictional government text

2

Confirm that personal information was removed

3

Click “Maak het duidelijk”

4

Show the four result sections + original text

Sources & project evidence

Key sources used for the problem definition and prototype.

Taalunie — Monitor Begrijpelijkheid overheidsteksten

At least 30% of the Dutch population has difficulty with government texts; abstract words, long sentences and unclear next steps are recurring problems.
taalunie.org/actueel/376/monitoronderzoek-overheidsteksten-te-moeilijk-voor-zeker-30-van-de-nederlandse-bevolking

Stichting Lezen en Schrijven

3 million people aged 16–75 in the Netherlands have difficulty with reading, writing and/or numeracy.
lezenenschrijven.nl/over-laaggeletterdheid/informatie-over-laaggeletterdheid-nederland

Prototype evidence

Python + Streamlit + Anthropic SDK. Live Claude API call, structured JSON response, validation, privacy confirmation and error handling are implemented in the ClearForMe prototype.

Thank you